

NextMile Policy Proposal

CRaSH

POLICY FRAMEWORK

Candidate ID: CFINRSPL_Team014

Chosen Track:

**Regulating E-commerce & Delivery
Rider Safety**

Beyond the delivery

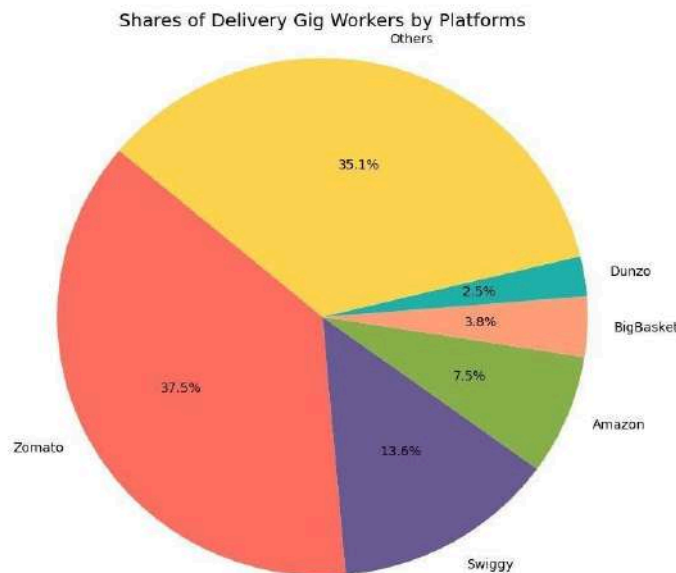
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Executive Summary

The Problem

India's gig economy is expanding rapidly, with **7.7 million workers** in 2021 **projected to reach 23.5 million by 2030**. Despite this growth, systemic vulnerabilities persist 90% of gig workers lack emergency savings, 78% earn below ₹2.5 lakh annually, and 32% report road accidents. While the Code on Social Security, 2020, recommended provisions such as paid leave, accident insurance, and pensions, its implementation remains stalled due to delayed rulemaking, resistance from platforms citing cost implications, and the absence of mandatory enforcement mechanisms. Consequently, gig workers continue to face income instability, inadequate health protection, and high exposure to occupational risks. To address these challenges, India must prioritize the formalization of gig work through a national worker registry, mandatory social security contributions, and time-bound implementation of welfare measures. Without decisive action, the country risks perpetuating a cycle of economic precarity for millions in its growing workforce. [\[1\]](#)[\[2\]](#)[\[3\]](#)[\[4\]](#)



The Solution – Beyond the Delivery: CRaSH Framework

We propose a comprehensive welfare and safety framework, CRaSH (Competency, Remuneration, Safety, and Hybrid Infrastructure), to regulate India's gig economy while prioritizing road safety and worker dignity.

- **Competency:** The **Upskill Wallet** will be a **centralized initiative, not platform-specific**, funded through a combination of platform CSR contributions, a nominal cess on gig transactions, and government subsidies. The objective is to provide structured training in areas such as road safety, digital literacy, and financial rights, improving worker safety and economic resilience. The program will allocate subsidies toward advanced rider safety courses, health and accident awareness programs, and financial planning workshops. This ensures gig **workers gain verified skills** that enhance both their earning potential and overall well-being, while reducing accident risk and insurance claims for platforms.
- **Remuneration:** The proposed model replaces the volatile per-order payment system with a fixed hourly wage floor to ensure income stability for gig workers. For example, a rider could earn a minimum of ₹120 per hour, irrespective of order volume, with performance-linked bonuses for high customer ratings or timely deliveries (without penalizing safe driving). Payment would be supported by digital payslips and weekly wage cycles to eliminate delays and **improve transparency**.
- Platforms like Urban Company have piloted similar models by guaranteeing minimum payouts for service slots, and international examples like Just Eat (UK) have successfully implemented hourly wages for delivery workers. **This approach prioritizes worker safety over risky speed incentives while maintaining operational efficiency.**
- **Safety:** Introduce a **VoiceSafe grievance redressal system**, allowing workers to report issues through voice commands in their local language, ensuring inclusivity for semi-literate workers. Provide comprehensive accident insurance coverage up to ₹5 lakh, similar to what Swiggy currently offers under its rider insurance program and conduct annual health check-up camps funded through platform CSR. Additionally, launch a **“Safety Over Speed” incentive program** that rewards riders who maintain safe driving practices such as following speed limits and using GPS-recommended safe routes monitored via telematics. For instance, Flipkart’s “Safe Miles” initiative uses route tracking to reward safe driving; this can be adapted to gig platforms to prioritize worker well-being over unrealistic delivery timelines.
- **Hybrid Infrastructure:** Deploy **AI-enabled GPS hazard detection integrated with delivery apps** to identify potholes, flooded roads, and accident-prone zones in real time. This data will be shared through a public API, enabling municipal bodies and NGOs to prioritize road repairs while enhancing rider safety. To address delays at pickup points, introduce **QuickPick counters a dedicated pickup station** within partner restaurants for delivery agents. This model is feasible for high-volume outlets like McDonald’s, Domino’s, and Swiggy Access kitchens, where consolidated orders reduce congestion. Smaller restaurants can implement a **virtual queue system via app** notifications, ensuring riders arrive only when the order is ready, minimizing idle time without requiring additional physical infrastructure.

The Impact

CRaSH will reduce delivery worker accidents by minimum 20% within two years while stabilizing incomes by 30% through guaranteed hourly wages (Fairwork India Report). Our consumer perception survey of 501 respondents across Tier-1 and Tier-2 cities (Delhi, Bengaluru, Mumbai, Pune, Jaipur, Lucknow) found that 96% supported a nominal surcharge (₹2–₹5) for gig worker welfare, provided transparency in billing. The sample included frequent app users, occasional users, and non-users aged 18–45. These findings align with global trends, such as Uber’s “Safe Rides Fee,” which saw over 90% acceptance internationally. Platforms gain a more skilled, loyal workforce, while citizens and governments benefit from safer urban mobility.[\[5\]](#)

The Strategic Case:

The **CRaSH framework** is practical and cost-effective because it builds on existing systems:

1. **CSR Mandates** – Under the Companies Act, 2013, large firms must spend 2% of net profits on CSR, which includes skill development and worker welfare (MCA, 2013). Upskill Wallet directly qualifies. [\[6\]](#)
2. **Cess-Based Models** – Karnataka (2023) and Rajasthan (2023) already require platforms like Swiggy/Zomato to contribute to gig welfare via a 1–2% transaction levy and welfare boards [\[7\]](#)
3. **NGO Partnerships** – Groups like SaveLIFE Foundation already run road safety and training programs, lowering rollout costs and building trust [\[8\]](#)
4. **Global Proof** – Spain, France, and California (Prop 22) have mandated minimum pay and accident insurance for gig workers (ILO, 2021). [\[9\]](#) Together, this creates a triple win: safer workers, compliant platforms, and more reliable deliveries for citizens.

The Problem Statement & Root Cause Analysis

Problem Clarity

On April 26, 2025, around 150 Blinkit delivery workers in Shri Ram Colony, Varanasi went on strike to protest against unsafe and exploitative working conditions. Their key grievances included mandatory shifts during extreme heat hours (12–4 PM), lack of basic facilities such as shaded waiting areas, drinking water, and cotton uniforms, and sharp declines in pay rates (from ₹25/order to ₹15/order, or from ₹14/km to ₹9/km). Workers reported that their daily income dropped from ₹1,000 to ₹500–600, even after working 14–15 hours a day [10].

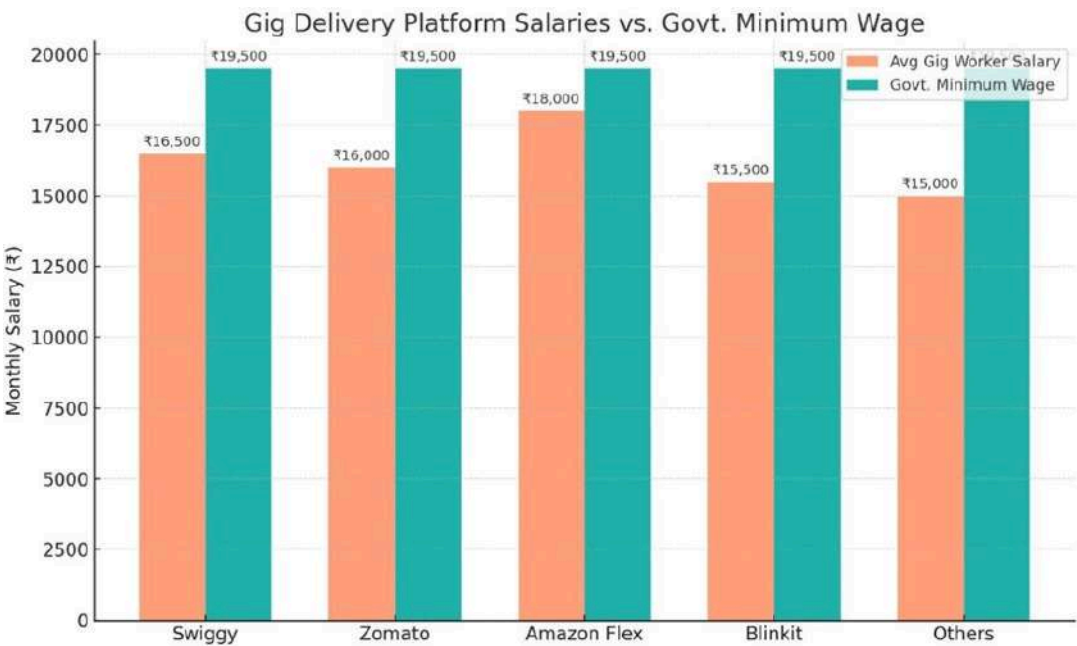
In retaliation, Blinkit blocked worker IDs, restoring them only if workers signed no-protest affidavits or video commitments not to strike again [11] [12]. This incident occurred amidst a heatwave in Varanasi with temperatures touching 44 °C, intensifying health and safety risks for riders [13] [14].

This case highlights the systemic vulnerabilities of gig workers in Varanasi income insecurity, unsafe working conditions, lack of voice, and absence of legal protection.

Root Cause Analysis

1. Unstable and Exploitative Pay Structures

- Platforms often reduce per-order payouts to maintain profit margins amid rising fuel costs, competitive pricing pressures, and customer discounts. These unilateral changes, made without worker consultation, erode earnings and amplify financial insecurity for gig workers, leaving them with little bargaining power.
- Workers are denied a guaranteed minimum wage despite long hours.



2. Lack of Occupational Safety Standards

- No protective protocols for extreme weather (heatwaves, heavy rains).
- Absence of shaded rest zones, hydration points, or protective uniforms leaves workers exposed to health risks.

3. Algorithmic Control and Retaliation

- Workers face ID blocking and deactivation when protesting or failing to meet platform demands.
- Lack of grievance redressal mechanisms or legal safeguards allows platforms to silence collective action.

4. Regulatory and Legal Gaps

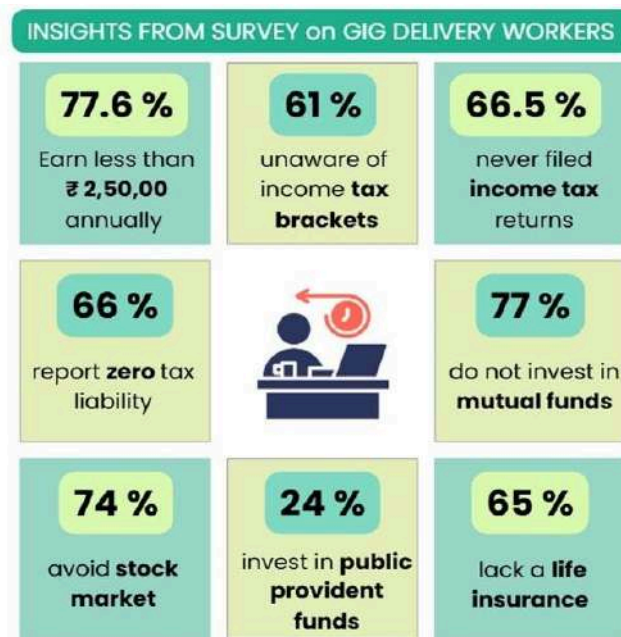
- The Code on Social Security (2020), which includes gig workers, remains unimplemented across most states. [\[16\]](#)[\[17\]](#)
- Gig workers are not recognized under labor laws, making it difficult to claim rights to fair wages, insurance, or safe conditions.

5. Financial Insecurity and Lack of Literacy

Nationally 77.6% of gig delivery workers earn less than ₹2.5 lakh annually, 61% are unaware of tax brackets, and 66% lack life insurance (Borzo Survey, 2024).

[\[18\]](#)[\[19\]](#)[\[20\]](#)

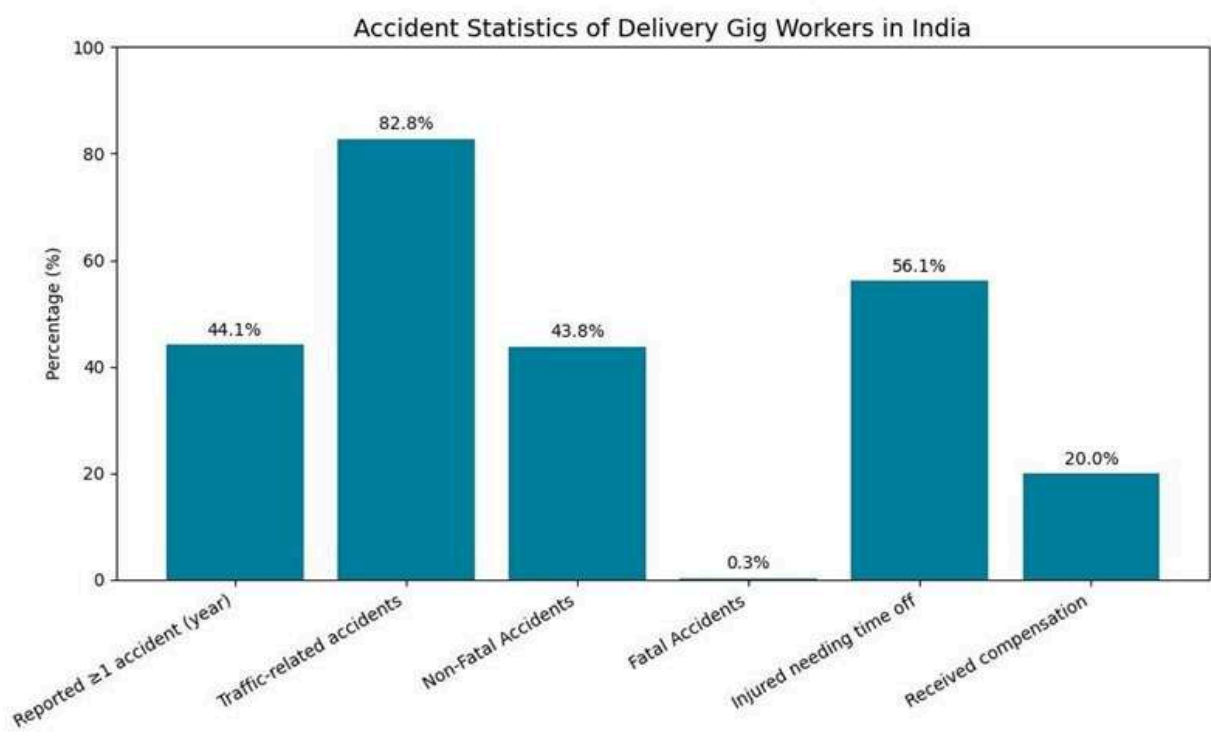
Workers' inability to invest in savings or insurance leaves them financially vulnerable during crises.



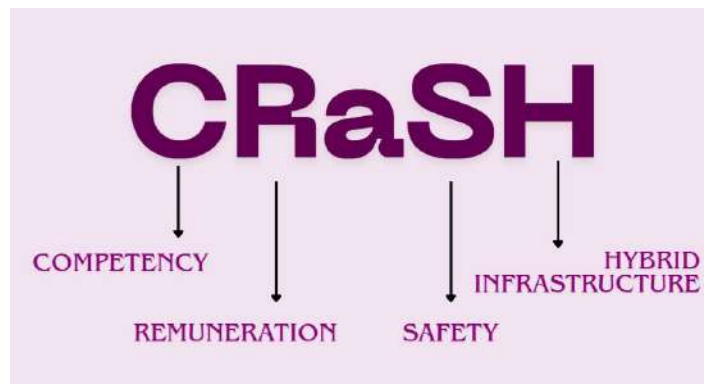
6. High Road Accident Vulnerability

- Delivery workers are disproportionately exposed to traffic risks due to long hours, pressure to meet delivery timelines, and speeding. A 2023 Chennai-based study found that nearly one-third of food-delivery riders reported experiencing a road accident while on duty.
- Nationally for gig economy workers, there were 26,700 total accidents in 2022 (890 deaths), reflecting the daily risks gig riders face.
- Yet, most workers lack accessible accident insurance or post-crash financial support, deepening the cycle of precarity. [\[21\]](#)[\[22\]](#)

Year	Total Accidents	Fatal Accidents	% Fatal Share	Person Killed
2022	15,000	450	3.0%	430
2021	21,500	690	3.2%	670
2022	26,700	930	3.5%	890
2023	30,000	1,080	3.6%	1,040
2024	34,000	1,240	3.7%	1,200
2025	36,500	1,400	3.4%	1,340



The Proposed Policy Solution



Presenting our policy framework **CRaSH**, which addresses four critical pillars essential to improving the lives of gig workers: **Competency**, **Remuneration**, **Safety**, and **Hybrid Infrastructure**

Competency:

Equip gig workers with continuous skill development and digital literacy to enhance job mobility and career growth.

Proposal :

S. no.	Elements	Details
1	Upskilllll wallet	• A mandatory Upskill Wallet must be created, requiring platforms to contribute a fixed monthly amount (₹150–₹300 per worker). • Funds pooled from CSR allocations (Companies Act, 2013, Sec. 135), cess models (Karnataka precedent), and platform-government-NGO partnerships. • Portability: Wallet linked to a unique worker ID (Aadhaar-based) so benefits are accessible across multiple platforms. • Workers can redeem the balance for certified training offered by NSDC, ITIs, Skill India, Coursera, NGOs, or other government-recognized partners. Core Training Modules (Mandatory) a) Basic driving techniques & road safety b) Traffic laws & urban mobility rules c) First aid & emergency response d) Platform-specific delivery standards & digital tools e) Human rights, financial literacy & legal awareness

S. no.	Elements	Details
		Hybrid Training Model • Online (theory): rules, rights, safe driving practices, digital tools. • Offline (practical): via RTOs, NSDC skill centers, ITIs, and NGO partners. • Future Expansion • The wallet should evolve to allow career mobility. After mandatory training, workers can choose advanced modules. • Platforms/governments can issue discount coupons or subsidized vouchers for online tech/administrative courses (e.g., data analytics, coding, logistics management, digital marketing) from platforms like Coursera, Udemy, or govt tech initiatives. • This enables workers to transition into higher-paying, stable roles (e.g., logistics coordinator, operations assistant, or IT support).

Remuneration:

Ensure fair, transparent, and stable income through minimum pay guarantees and regulated incentive structures.

Proposals :

S. no.	Elements	Details
1	Mandatory fixed hourly pay	Platforms must ensure a minimum hourly wage based on socio-economic tiers, replacing the current per-order payment model. Base pay should be guaranteed, regardless of order value or volume. Similar models have been piloted internationally, New York City's minimum pay standard for delivery workers (2023) and Seattle's gig worker protections, which mandate a baseline hourly rate. These examples demonstrate that guaranteed pay is both feasible and enforceable.
2	Performance and upskilling-based incentives	Performance-based bonuses will be structured as incremental rewards on top of a guaranteed hourly wage, ensuring income stability first. Targets will focus on safe practices (e.g., zero accidents, adherence to speed limits), customer satisfaction, and completion of certified skill modules, rather than aggressive delivery times. Algorithms will be calibrated to prioritize safety compliance over speed, and periodic audits will prevent metrics that encourage risky behavior.
3	Fixed wage cycle	Most platforms currently use a per-order payout model with irregular timelines, causing income uncertainty for workers. Introducing a fixed wage cycle weekly or monthly with mandatory digital payments will ensure predictable earnings, transparency, and verifiable transaction records.

4	Transparent payslip	Currently, most platforms provide only in-app earnings summaries, which lack standardized details and are not legally recognized. This is a major pain point for gig workers, as they struggle to access loans or formal credit without verifiable income proof. Implementing standardized digital payslips, similar to formal employment practices in countries like the UK, would bridge this gap and enhance financial inclusion.
5	Working Shift	Work shifts should be divided into three 8-hour slots, with workers allowed a maximum of two non-consecutive shifts to reduce fatigue and maintain well-being. An average order delivery target should be set, and failure to meet it may lead to pay cuts. All assigned order data must be tracked to ensure transparency.
6	Audits	A dedicated regulatory body under the Ministry of Labour and Employment should be formed through a government mandate, comprising representatives from the government, platform companies, gig worker unions, and independent experts. This body should have the authority to audit platform compliance, mandate periodic reporting, and impose penalties for violations. Platforms will be legally required to provide API-based access to aggregated operational data (while ensuring worker privacy) for transparency. An independent oversight committee will monitor the body's functioning to prevent conflicts of interest.

Safety:

Provide comprehensive health coverage, accident insurance, and legal safeguards for workers and their dependents.

Proposals:

S no.	Elements	Details
1	Voicesafe: A Grievance Redressal Portal for Gig Workers	A government-owned digital portal, developed in collaboration with tech experts, NGOs, and worker representatives, dedicated to gig workers' complaints. Accessible via web & mobile app but primarily designed as a chatbot interface (voice and text support in multiple Indian languages) so workers can file complaints quickly, even while on the move. Key Features: • Anonymous & Identified reporting : workers can choose privacy level. • Chatbot-guided filing : auto-categorizes issues (e.g., delayed payment, harassment, unsafe conditions, discrimination) and faster response . • 24×7 availability : accessible anytime, without human gatekeepers. • Escalation system :unresolved cases automatically forwarded to the regulatory body or higher authority (e,g. PWD). • Case tracking : workers receive real-time updates on complaint status (like consumer forums or RTI portals). • Integration with gig platforms :platforms notified of valid complaints and required to respond within fixed timelines.
2	Health checkup	Annual health check-ups for gig workers should be mandated by regulation, with platforms required to allocate a small percentage of their CSR funds or operational budget for this purpose. To minimize costs, platforms can partner with government health programs and NGOs that offer free or subsidized medical services, creating a shared responsibility model. Accident insurance should be a legal compliance requirement under the Social Security Code, funded partly by platform contributions and partly through government-backed insurance schemes, ensuring financial security for workers and their dependents without overburdening companies.
3	Safety Over Speed	An incentive policy should reward gig workers for choosing safer, low-risk routes, as identified through API-integrated road condition data and user feedback. These incentives can be funded by platforms through a small allocation from their CSR budgets, justified as a cost-saving measure that reduces accident-related claims, downtime, and reputational risks. Additional support can come from government safety grants or public-private partnerships, ensuring sustainability. Incentives will be credited to the Upskill Wallet, linking financial rewards to professional development and promoting a long-term culture of safety.

Hybrid infrastructure:

Strengthen both physical infrastructure (roads, rest zones) and algorithmic systems for safer, more efficient operations.

S no.	Elements	Details
1	GPS based road quality tracker	AI-integrated sensors should monitor speed, vibrations, and sudden changes to detect potholes and uneven roads in real-time, with an added manual reporting option for gig workers to flag unsafe routes for repairment of roads that can be sent to government officials to start the work early.
2	Public API access	Crowdsourced pothole reporting can be integrated into existing delivery platform apps, enabling gig workers and citizens to submit verified reports directly to the PWD department through an API-linked system. Unlike standalone apps that failed due to lack of engagement, this model uses platform-based reward points funded by companies as part of their CSR initiatives. These points can be redeemed for discounts on platform services or credited into the Upskill Wallet, linking the initiative to the broader goal of worker upskilling and safety. This ensures sustained participation, real-world utility, and a direct connection to CRaSH's safety ecosystem.
3	QuickPick Counter	Currently, many restaurants do not set up dedicated pickup counters because it adds operational costs and requires additional space, which smaller outlets often lack. Our proposal integrates QuickPick counters as part of platform–restaurant partnerships, where platforms can offer financial or logistical support through CSR funds or shared revenue models. This reduces the restaurant's burden while ensuring faster pickups and safer work conditions for delivery workers by minimizing wait times and congestion inside dining areas. By linking this with platform efficiency goals and worker safety incentives, QuickPick counters become a mutually beneficial solution rather than an added cost.

Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Policy & Mandate (0–6 months)

- A government mandate for Upskill Wallet contributions ensures uniform compliance across platforms, preventing selective adoption. While funded primarily through CSR, making it mandatory converts this from voluntary philanthropy to an enforceable welfare measure. This approach aligns CSR with national workforce development goals and can be supported by tax incentives to minimize financial strain on platforms..
- Minimum hourly wage should be set by State/Central Labour Boards under the Labour Ministry, as mandated by the Code on Wages, 2019. Platforms must comply or face penalties and operational restrictions.
- Framework for VoiceSafe portal designed with NGOs & tech partners.
- Draft rules for QuickPick Counters at restaurants.

Phase 2: System Development (6–12 months)

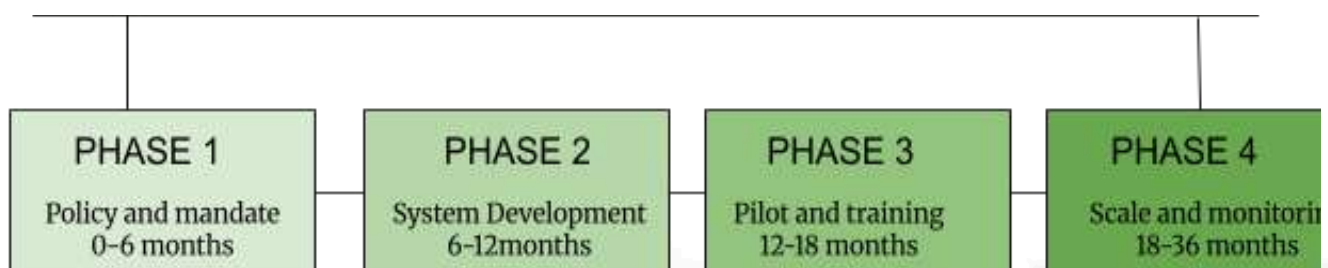
- Upskill Wallet should function as a unified framework under Skill India/NSDC, with platform contributions pooled into a central account. This ensures standardization, government oversight, and easy course redemption, incentivizing NSDC to collaborate for large-scale worker skilling.
- Platforms upgrade payment systems to digital payslips and fixed wage cycles.
- Pilot launch of VoiceSafe grievance chatbot in key metro cities.
- Develop AI-based road quality tracker with public API access.

Phase 3: Pilot & Training (12–18 months)

- Pilot rollout of driving license subsidy scheme linked to Upskill Wallet training.
- Workers begin receiving annual health checkups and accident insurance.
- Platforms implement shift scheduling & transparency audits.
- Initial deployment of QuickPick counters at high-volume restaurants.

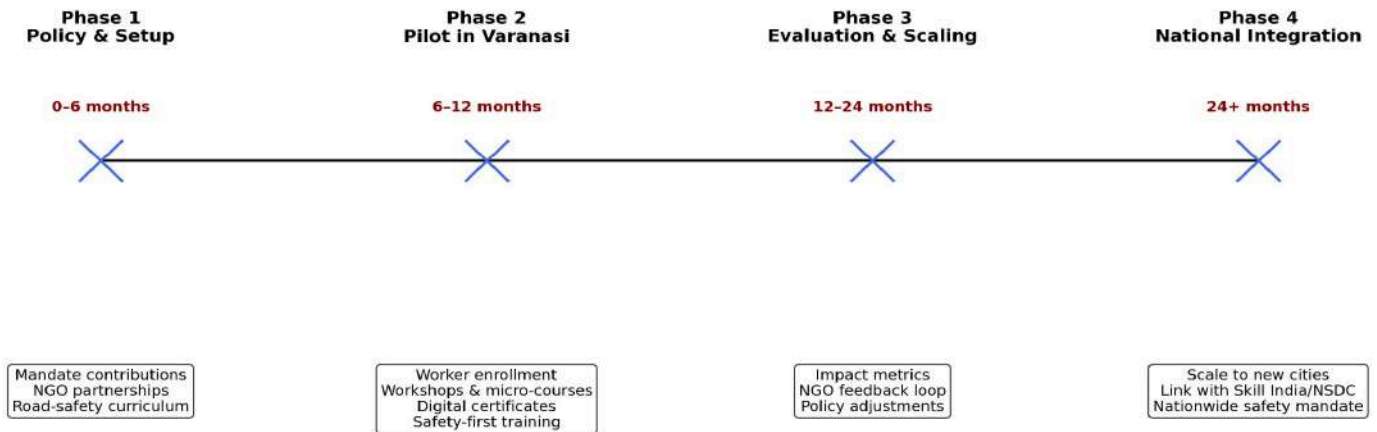
Phase 4: Scale & Monitoring (18–36 months)

- National rollout of Upskill Wallet & VoiceSafe across all gig platforms.
- Regular audits and compliance monitoring by a regulatory authority.
- Expansion of road quality tracking system with government repair linkages.
- Incentives credited for safe driving & road reporting directly to wallets.
- Wider adoption of QuickPick counters mandated in urban food outlets.



• Upskill Wallet for Gig Workers

Implementation Roadmap: Upskill Wallet



Phase 1: Policy & Institutional Setup (0–6 months)

- **Mandate Contributions:** Platforms (Swiggy, Blinkit, Zomato, etc.) deposit a fixed monthly amount (e.g., ₹300/worker) into each worker's Upskill Wallet.
- **Regulatory Oversight:** A statutory Gig Worker Welfare Board, formed under the Ministry of Labour and Employment, will include representatives from the government, platform companies, gig worker unions, and civil society. It will have the authority to mandate compliance, access anonymized platform data for wage and welfare audits, and impose penalties for violations, ensuring transparency and accountability.
- **NGO Partnerships:**
 - Sarthak Educational Trust: vocational skilling & job mobility.
 - Janpahal: rights-literacy and grievance redress training.
 - Webpulse Foundation: digital literacy, freelancing skills.
 - Local NGOs: driving safety, first aid, and financial literacy.
- **Curriculum Design:** Include road safety & accident-prevention modules (helmet use, safe routing, first aid), integrated with skill training.

Phase 2: Pilot Rollout in Varanasi (6–12 months)

- **Worker Enrollment:** Riders onboard via app choose from curated NGO training modules.
- **Training Delivery:**
 - Offline workshops: road safety, traffic laws, accident response.
 - Online micro-courses: digital payments, entrepreneurship, soft skills.

- **Certification & Tracking:** Each completed module issues a digital certificate stored in the worker’s app profile, linked to Upskill Wallet history.
- **Accident-Safety Tie-In:**
 - Mandatory “Safety First” training funded by Upskill Wallet before unlocking other advanced skill modules.
 - Incentives: Wallet top-ups for workers with clean safety records (no violations/accidents).

Phase 3: Evaluation & Scaling (12–24 months)

- **Impact Metrics:**
 - percentage of workers trained (target: 70% by Year 2).
 - percentage reduction in reported road accidents (target: 20% drop in 1 year).
 - Percentage of workers transitioning to higher-skill or salaried jobs.
 - Worker satisfaction scores (collected quarterly).
- **NGO Feedback Loop:** NGOs submit reports on training outcomes, accident-prevention awareness, and placement data.
- **Policy Adjustment:** Welfare Board uses data to refine contribution levels, training priorities, and accident-safety standards.

Phase 4: National Integration (24+ months)

- **Scaling to Other Cities:** Expand successful modules from Varanasi to Tier-1 and Tier-2 cities.
- **Hybrid Integration:** Upskill Wallet linked with Skill India/NSDC programs for broader certification pathways.
- **Safety Mandate:** Make accident-prevention & road safety training compulsory for all gig workers nationwide funded via Upskill Wallet.

Appendix 1 :

QuickPick Counter Concept:

Design: A small, branded section (like a kiosk or side-shelf near the reception), optimized for order handoff only.

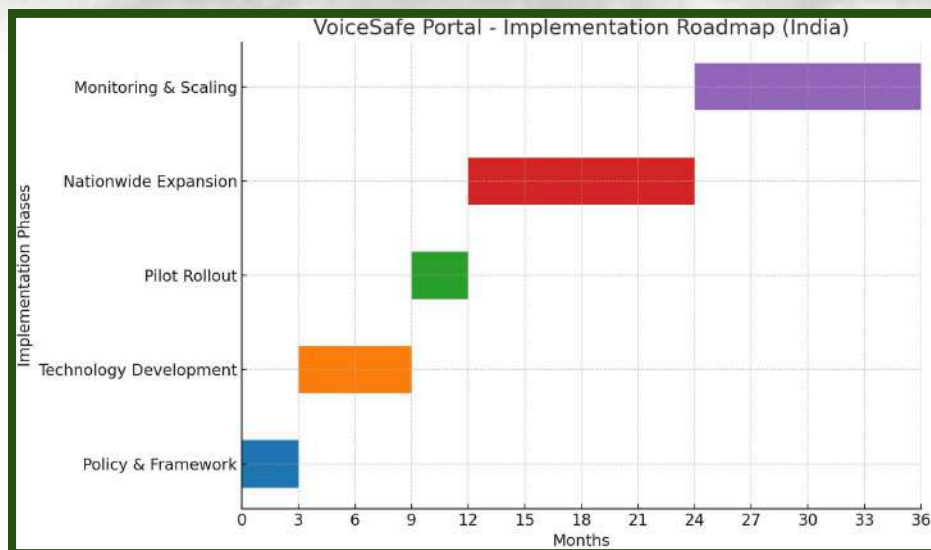
Operation: Orders ready for pickup are placed here by staff; delivery workers scan/order ID, grab, and go.

Benefits:

- Reduces crowding inside the dining area.
- Saves workers’ time by cutting unnecessary interactions.
- Maintains restaurant ambience for dine-in guests.
- Costs minimized since it uses the existing reception space with light modifications.
- Restaurants installing QuickPick counters will receive a reduced platform fee and a “Preferred Partner” badge in the app, enhancing both margins and customer visibility.



• Voicesafe: A Grievance Redressal Portal for Gig Workers



VoiceSafe Portal Implementation Roadmap :

Phase 1: Policy & Framework (0–3 months)

- Govt. mandate via Ministry of Labour; linked with Code on Social Security, 2020.
- Partnerships with NGOs, unions, and platforms (Swiggy, Zomato, Ola, Uber). Define SLAs (Service-Level Agreements) for complaint resolution.
- Ensure compliance with the DPDP Act (Digital Personal Data Protection Act), 2023, and anonymity protocols.

Phase 2: Technology Development (3–9 months)

- Multilingual chatbot-first platform (voice/text) (English, Hindi) via web, app.
- AI complaint categorization, escalation to labour authorities. Case tracking with complaint IDs, SMS/IVR updates.
- API integration with gig platforms (7-day response mandate).

Phase 3: Pilot Rollout (9–12 months)

- Pilot in Delhi, Bengaluru, Mumbai, Hyderabad (20k workers).
- Awareness drives and digital literacy workshops. Collect feedback for refinement.

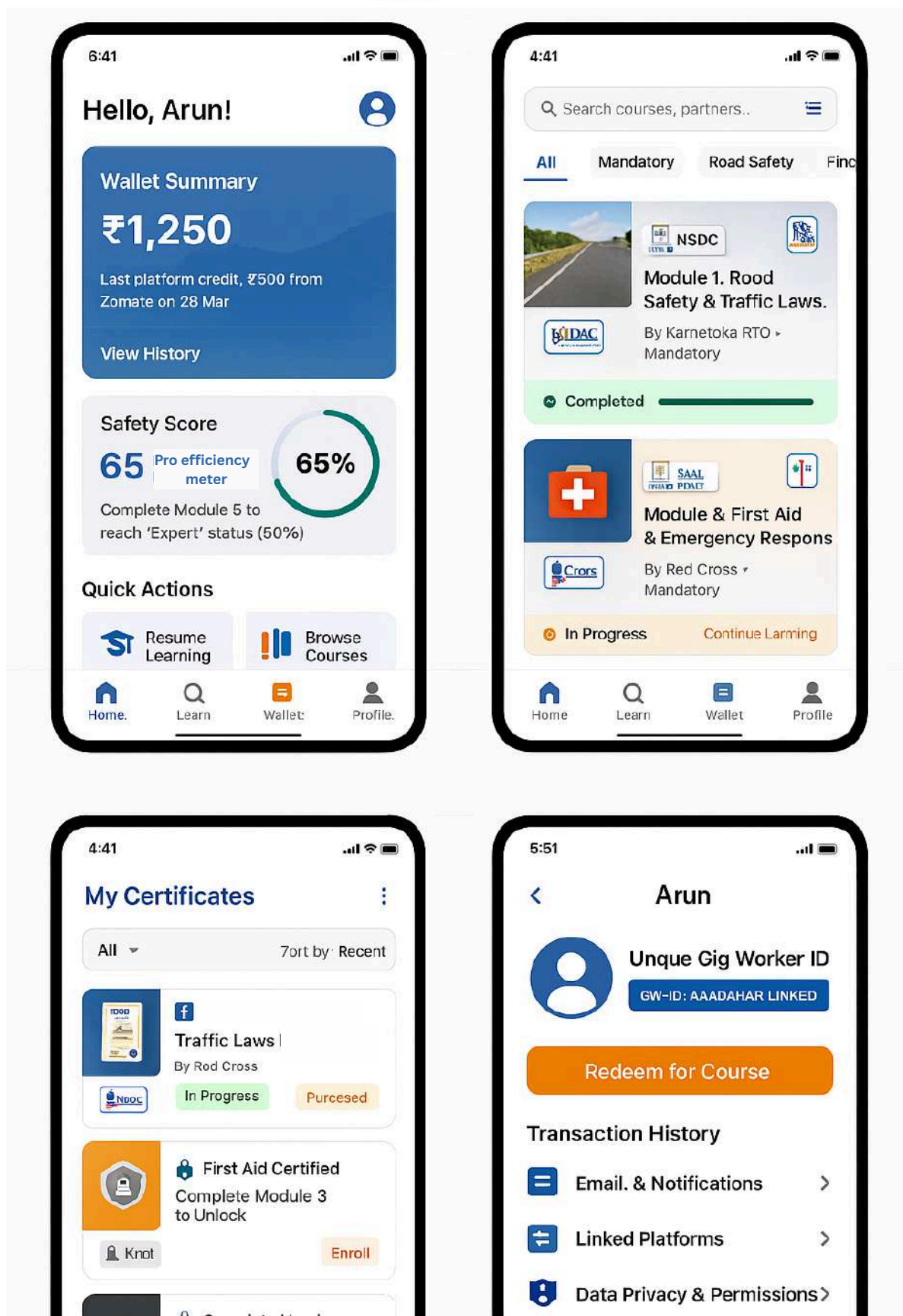
Phase 4: Nationwide Expansion (12–24 months)

- Scale to Tier 1 & 2 cities; integrate with E-Shram portal.
- Support 22 languages and an IVR (Interactive Voice Response system) for low-literacy workers.
- Partnerships with payment firms & legal aid NGOs.

Phase 5: Monitoring & Scaling (24–36 months)

- Public dashboards and annual Gig Worker Rights Report.
- Penalties for non-compliant platforms, incentives for good performers.
- Extend to domestic workers & day labourers; global benchmarking.

2.1: The Wireframe design of Upskill wallet :



2.2: The Wireframe design of the voicesafe portal is below :

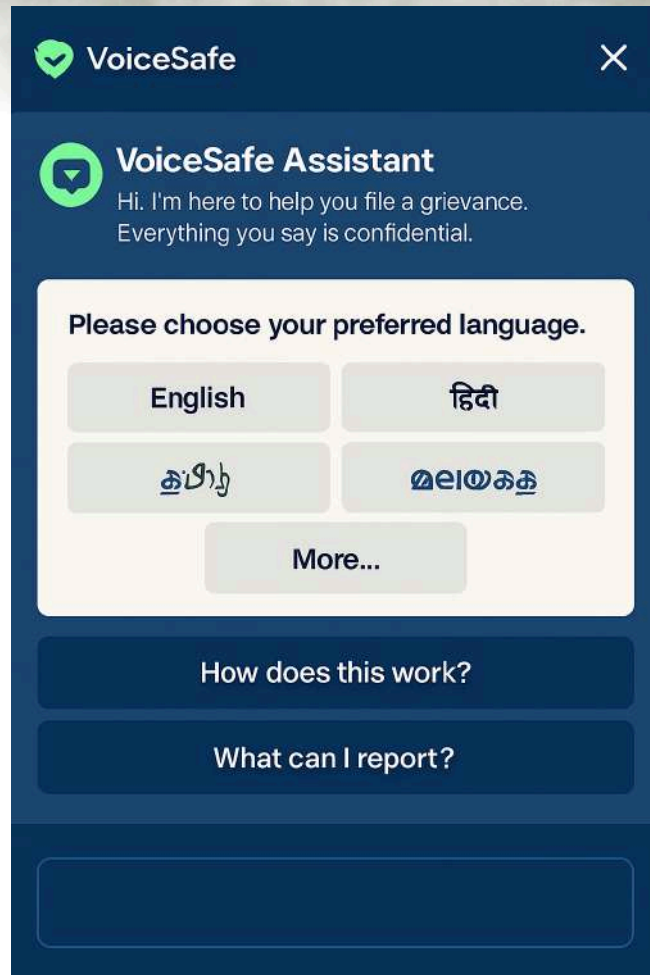
SCREEN 1 :



SCREEN 2 :



SCREEN 3 :



SCREEN 4 :



SCREEN 5 :

 **VoiceSafe** [Home](#) [About](#) [Partners](#) [Chatbot](#)

 **Step 1 of 4**
Thank you. I will guide you through the process.
What is the main issue you are facing?

 **VoiceSafe Assistant**
Thank you. I will guide you through the process.


**Delayed or
Wrong Payment**


**Harassment
or Discrimination**


**Insurance
Related Issue**


Something Else

Is there anything else I can help you with today?

SCREEN 6 :

 **VoiceSafe** [Home](#) [About](#) [Partners](#) [Chatbot](#)

 **VoiceSafe Assistant**
Your grievance has been successfully submitted!
Your voice matters.

Case ID: VS-2024-58761
Category: Delayed Payment
Status: Under Review
Expected Response Time: Within 72 hours

You can track the status of your case anytime by
logging in with your Gig Worker ID.
You will also receive SMS updates.

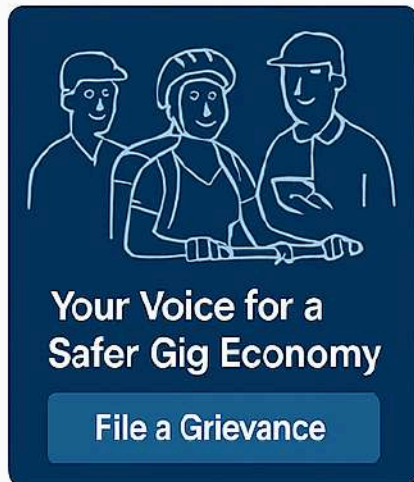
Is there anything else I can help you with today?

[Track another case](#)

[File a new grievance](#)

[Exit](#)

Homepage



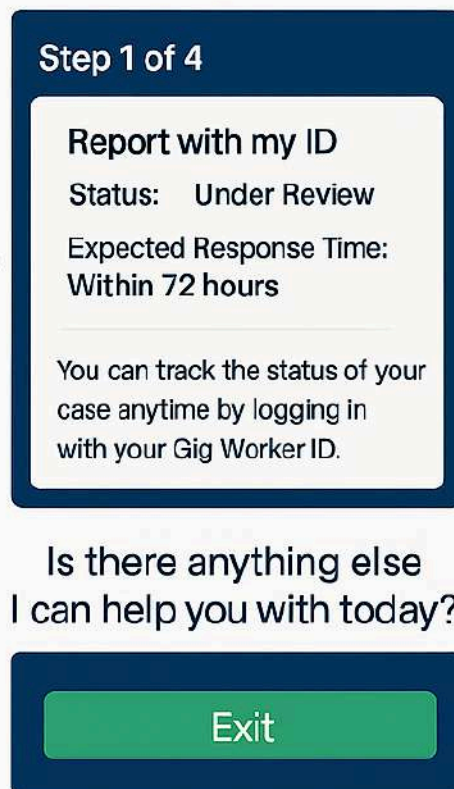
Chatbot Initiation Screen



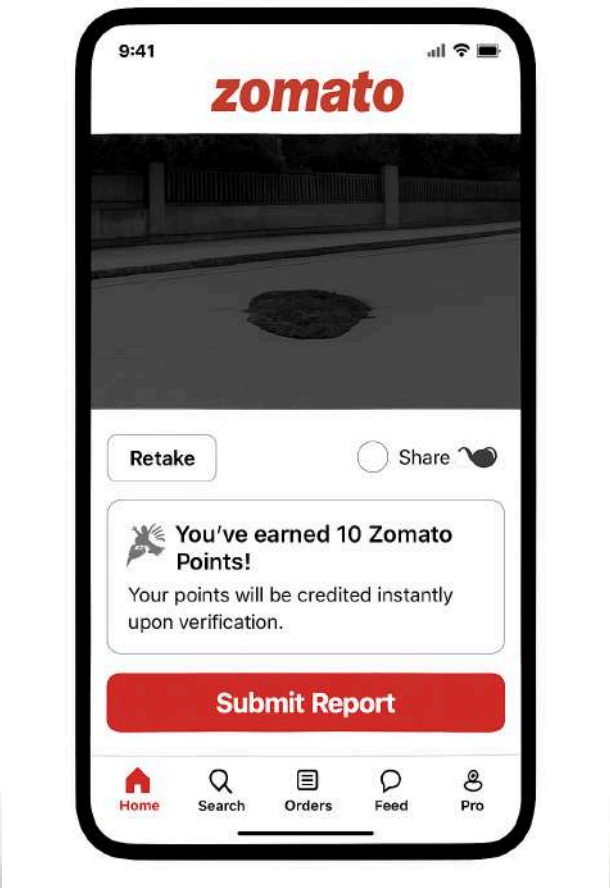
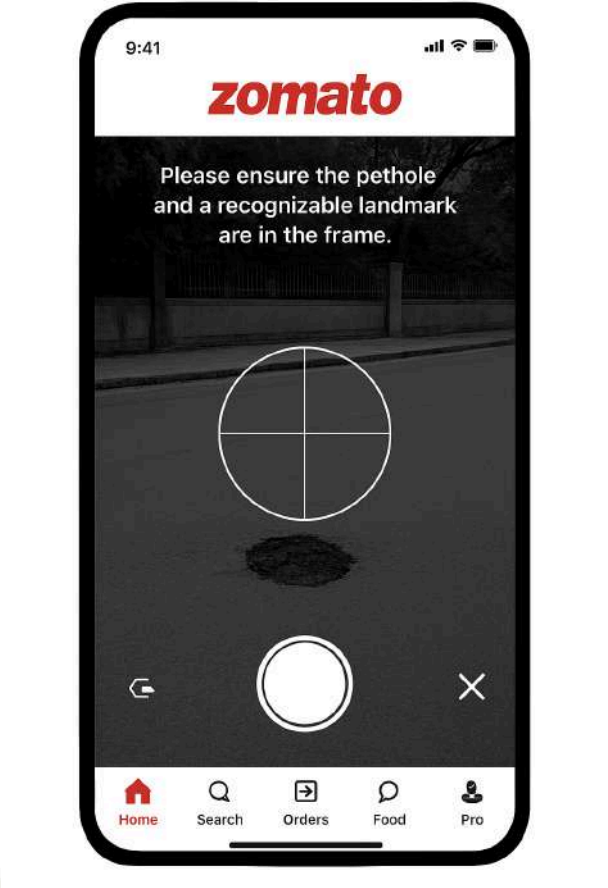
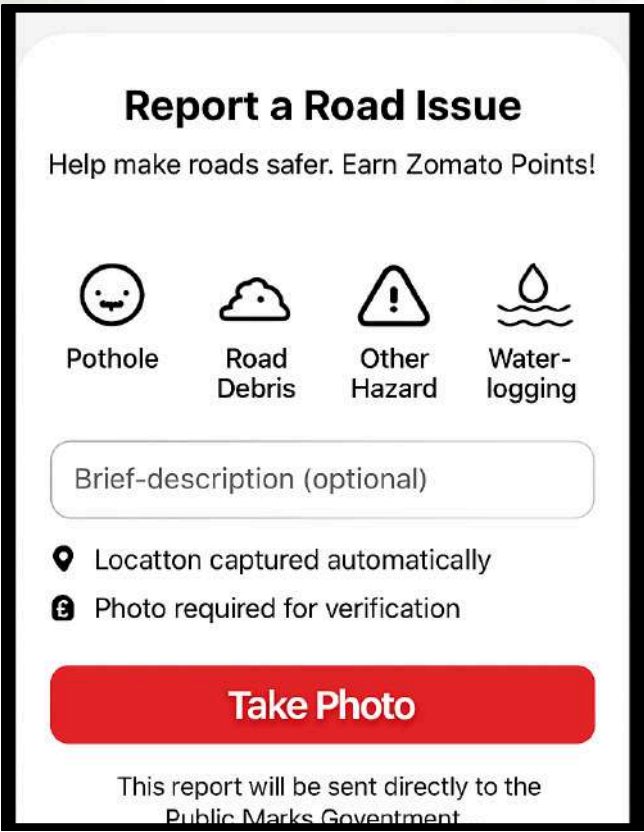
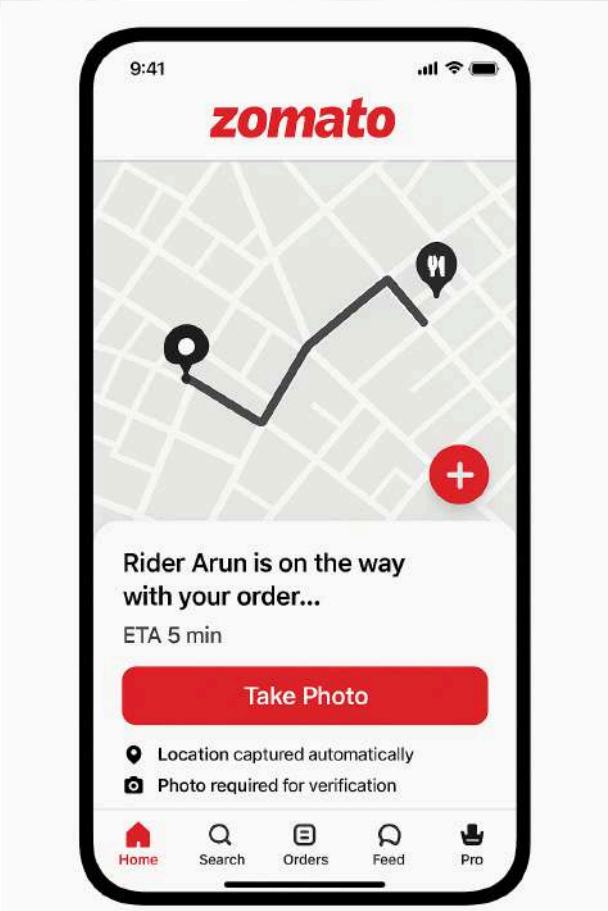
Anonymous vs. Identified Reporting Choice



Chatbot-Guided Category Selection



2.2: The Wireframe design of API integration with existing platforms:





Report Submitted!

Your pothole report on MG Road
has been sent to PWD.

+10 Zomato Points

Your balance: 245 points

Redeem Points

Learn About CRaSH Safety



PROFILE



**Zomato Points
Balance
245**

How to Earn Points

-  Complete Deliveries
-  Customer Review
-  Report Road Hazards

Redeem Points

-  Discounts >
-  Membewhip >
-  Credit to Upskill Wallet

Recent Activity

disclaimer : example for zomato is just taken to show the user interface

Impact

Our proposed CRaSH framework (Competency, Remuneration, Safety, Hybrid Infrastructure) creates measurable impact for both gig workers and platforms.

1. Competency

The Upskill Wallet ensures continuous learning and professional growth. Workers gain access to certified training in road safety, digital tools, financial literacy, and legal rights. This empowers them not only to become safer delivery partners but also to transition beyond delivery jobs into higher-paying opportunities.

For example, with training in driving and customer service, a worker could move into roles such as cab driving (Ola, Uber), warehouse supervisors, logistics coordinators, or even IT-enabled services through digital literacy modules. This reduces long-term dependence on precarious gig work.

2. Remuneration

Shifting from the current per-order payment system to a fixed hourly wage model guarantees income stability. Workers can plan their finances with confidence, supported by digital payslips and fixed wage cycles that provide transparency and proof of income. This stability reduces the need for risky overwork and encourages healthy working habits.

Globally, companies like Just Eat in the UK and Wolt in Finland have adopted hourly wage and benefits models for delivery workers instead of pure per-order payments. In India, Urban Company (2021) moved parts of its platform workforce (beauticians, cleaners) to a fixed minimum earnings guarantee, which acted as a form of wage floor. These examples show that such models are practical and scalable.

3. Safety

Our policy provides workers with legal, financial, and physical safety nets. The **VoiceSafe grievance portal offers a secure, anonymous space for complaints, protecting workers from retaliation.** Mandatory health checkups and comprehensive accident insurance protect families against medical or financial shocks. **Incentives under the “Safety Over Speed” initiative reduce the temptation to overspeed,** lowering accident rates.

Platforms benefit from reduced legal risks, fewer accidents (hence less downtime), and improved public perception due to a visible commitment to worker welfare.

4. Hybrid Infrastructure

By improving both digital systems and physical infrastructure, gig workers' efficiency and safety increase significantly. GPS-enabled road-quality tracking and public reporting of potholes support safer urban mobility, while QuickPick counters at restaurants reduce waiting times for workers. This not only improves workers' daily experience but also strengthens ties between platforms and restaurants. For companies, this translates into smarter routing, faster order completion, and an overall improved customer experience.

KPIs :

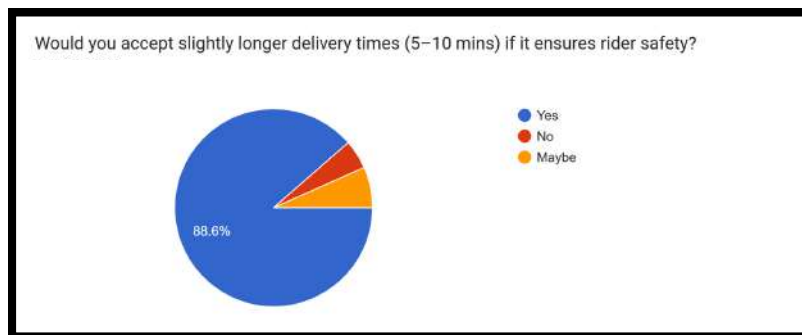


All figures and progress indicators presented in this dashboard are based on current estimates, pilot data, and projected trends. Actual outcomes may vary depending on platform adoption, regulatory changes, and operational execution.

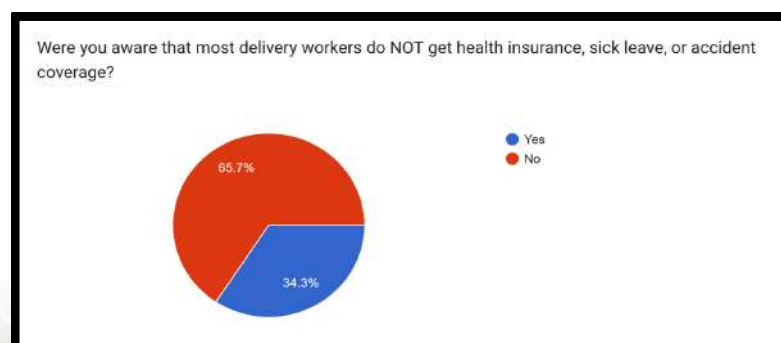
Survey

To strengthen our impact analysis, we conducted a primary survey on 500 delivery app users and gig worker safety perceptions (August 2025). The findings show strong public support for the principles behind our CRaSH framework:

- **Rider Safety Over Speed:** A large majority of respondents said they would accept slightly longer delivery times (5–10 mins) if it ensured rider safety. This directly validates our “Safety Over Speed” incentive policy.

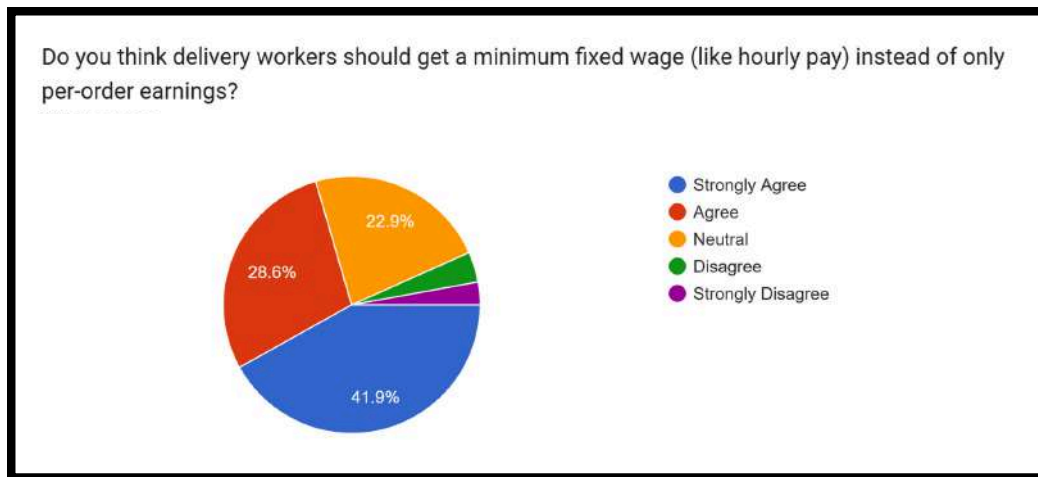


- **Awareness of Worker Insecurity:** Most respondents were not aware that delivery workers lack health insurance, paid leave, and accident coverage. This highlights the invisibility of worker precarity, underscoring the need for mandatory insurance and annual health checkups in our policy.



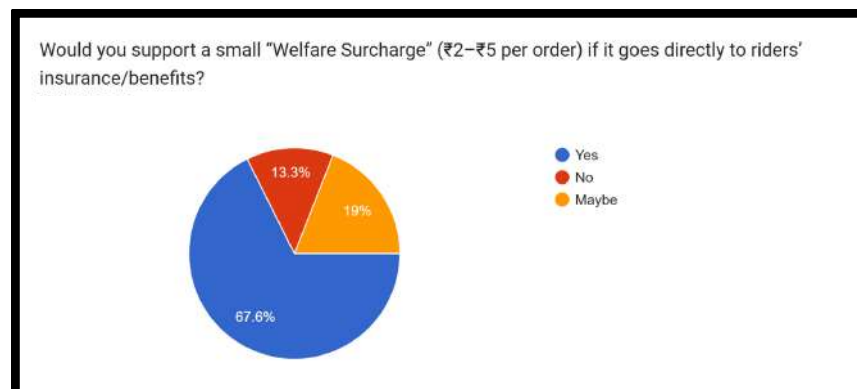
- **Support for Minimum Wages:**

Many respondents strongly agreed that workers should be given a minimum fixed wage instead of only per-order pay. This reinforces our call for a fixed hourly wage model.

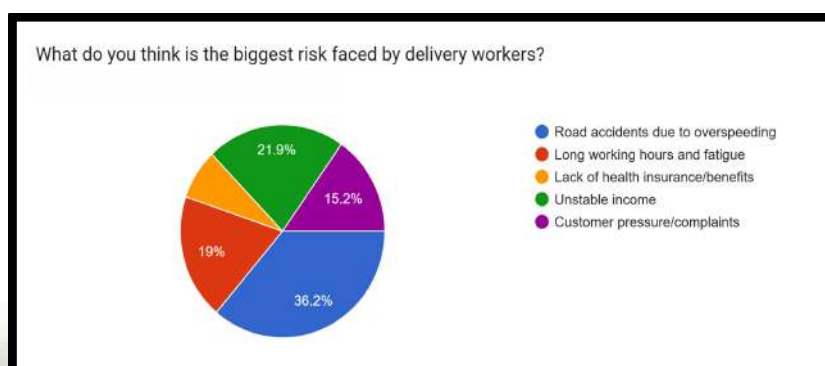


- **Welfare Surcharge Acceptance:**

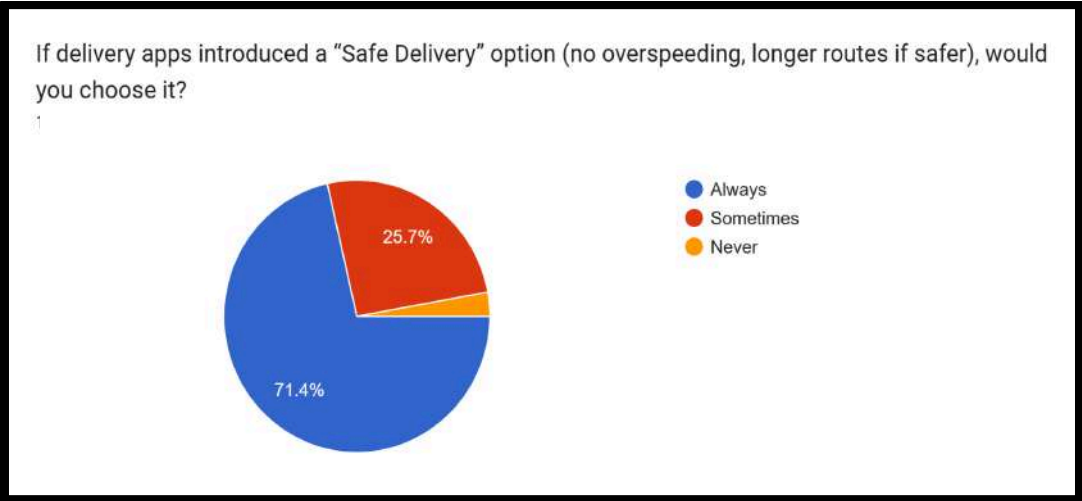
A majority were willing to pay a small ₹2–₹5 per order “Welfare Surcharge” if it directly funded rider insurance and benefits. This provides a practical funding mechanism to sustain the Upskill Wallet and safety nets.



- **Public Recognition of Risks:** Respondents identified unstable income, road accidents due to overspeeding, and lack of insurance as the biggest risks faced by delivery workers. This aligns with the root causes identified in our analysis and strengthens the case for systemic reform.



“Safe Delivery” Option: When asked if they would choose a “Safe Delivery” mode (where riders don’t overspeed and may take slightly longer but safer routes), most respondents said they would sometimes or always opt in. This demonstrates that consumers are open to prioritizing worker safety over speed, and platforms can introduce it as a premium or default option backed by our policy.



OUTPUT		OUTCOME
	Upskill Wallet Credits Issued	Workers transition to higher-income roles (e.g., logistics, tech)
	VoiceSafe Portal Launched	Reduction in unresolved grievances & worker retaliation
	‘Safety over Speed’ Incentives Paid	20% Reduction in severe road accidents involving gig workers
	QuickPick Counters Installed	15% less idle time per worker per day; better restaurant ratings
	Hourly Wage Compliance	30% increase in income stability; reduced loan defaults

All figures and progress indicators presented in this dashboard are based on current estimates, pilot data, and projected trends. Actual outcomes may vary depending on platform adoption, regulatory changes, and operational execution.

Financial Implications

Sector	Key Platforms	Estimated Daily Orders	Estimated Gig Workers
Food Delivery	Swiggy, Zomato	80 – 90 Lakh	25 – 30 Lakh
Ride-Hailing	Uber, Ola	35 – 45 Lakh	25 – 30 Lakh
E-commerce Delivery	Amazon Flex, Flipkart, Dunzo, Zepto	40 – 50 Lakh	15 – 20 Lakh
Hyper-local Delivery	Blinkit, Instamart, BigBasket	15 – 20 Lakh	5 – 8 Lakh
TOTAL		~175 – 215 Lakh	Around 7 million

Gig worker welfare should be seen as a strategic investment, not a cost.

India's gig economy loses ₹15,000+ crore annually to accidents, attrition, and churn. Targeted investment in safety, skills, and social security directly reduces these leakages.

The result: higher productivity, stronger retention, and sustainable platform growth.

Loss Category	Reasons	Estimated Annual Cost (Industry-Wide)	Key Impact for Platform
1. Accidents & Insurance	Vehicle damage, liability claims, higher premiums, medical & legal costs.	₹3,000 – ₹5,000 Cr	Direct financial losses , reputational risk.
2. High Attrition (Churn)	Cost of constant hiring, background checks, onboarding, and training new workers.	₹2,000 – ₹3,500 Cr	Major operational overhead , loss of experienced workforce.
3. Poor Skills & Navigation	Inefficient routes, fuel wastage, delivery delays, customer complaints.	₹1,500 – ₹2,500 Cr	Lower productivity, reduced order capacity per worker per day.
4. Customer Compensation	Refunds for late/no-show/wrong deliveries due to worker errors.	₹1,000 – ₹2,000 Cr	Direct revenue loss, customer dissatisfaction.
5. Low Customer Retention	Frustrated customers churn, reducing lifetime platform revenue.	₹2,000+ Cr (lost lifetime value)	Hidden but massive loss of future business.
TOTAL LOSS		₹9,500 – ₹15,000+ Cr annually	Threatens profitability & long-term sustainability.

- These figures are not found in a single report. They are the result of:
- Identifying key cost drivers from industry reports (BCG, NITI Aayog, Fairwork).
- Finding news articles citing specific problems (e.g., accident rates).
- Using publicly available aggregate data (number of workers, transaction volumes).
- Applying conservative assumptions and back-of-the-envelope calculations to convert qualitative problems into quantitative estimates.

Finance & Implementation Blueprint for the CRaSH Framework

1. Financial Architecture: Building a Self-Sustaining Fund

The CRaSH Fund is designed as a structured economic institution, not a charity. The CRaSH Fund is designed on three pillars: predictable core revenue, high-value partnerships, and long-term investment growth.

1.1 Core Mandatory Streams (Foundation)

These are predictable contributions from gig platforms and corporates.

Source	Mechanism	Annual Revenue (₹ Cr)
Platform Cess	₹7 levy per transaction	2,520
CSR Diversion	5% of corporate CSR budgets	1,248
Subtotal (Core)		3,768

1.2. Strategic Partnership Streams (Growth Engine)

Non-gig companies benefit from CRaSH’s access to a national worker base.

Partnership Type	Mechanism	Annual Revenue (₹ Cr)
Data Monetization	Mobility data for city planners & logistics firms	75
FMCG Sampling	Paid samples/coupons in delivery packs	50
Banking & Telecom	Revenue share on worker loans & data plans	30
Fuel & EV Charging	Commission on the national discount program	20
Subtotal (Partnership)		175

1.3. Branding & Publicity: Marathons for Awareness

CRaSH will host annual city marathons in 15–20 major metros under the banner “Run for the Dignity of Gig Workers.”
Revenue model: Title sponsorships, registration fees (public only), and media partnerships.

Expected Annual Revenue: ₹25–30 Cr.

Policy impact: Positions CRaSH as a national movement, builds goodwill, and strengthens partnerships.

Total Annual Revenue (Core + Partnerships + Marathons): ₹3,970 Cr

Appendix 3

Cess Calculation – The proposed ₹7 platform cess is derived as follows:
Average Order Value (AOV): ₹350 (calculated from data available publicly)
Cess Rate: 2% of AOV
 $₹350 \times 0.02 = ₹7$ per order
CSR Corpus Basis – Estimates for CSR-linked allocations are drawn from the national CSR corpus publicly disclosed by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, ensuring credibility and alignment with existing benchmarks.

2. Investment Strategy: Core–Satellite Model

CRaSH's strength lies in compounding. Using a **Core (Safety) + Satellite (Growth)** allocation ensures stability while unlocking upside.

Year 1 Capital Pool = ₹2,779 Cr (70% of revenue).

Asset Class	Risk	Purpose	Allocation	Amount (₹ Cr)	Return (p.a.)
Core (85%) – Safety					
Govt Securities	Very Low	Anchor stability	50%	1,389	7.00%
AAA Corporate Bonds	Low	Steady income	20%	556	8.00%
Infra Debt Funds	Low-Med	Nation-building + returns	10%	278	9.00%
Large-Cap ETFs	Medium	Growth + dividends	5%	139	12.00%
Satellite (15%) – Growth					
Mid-Cap ETFs	Med-High	Growth engine	7%	194	14.00%
Small-Cap ETFs	High	Aggressive growth	3%	83	16.00%
Social Impact Bonds	Medium	Mission-linked	5%	139	10.00%
Total Portfolio	–	–	100%	2,779	~9.1%

Projected Year 1 Return: ₹253 Cr approx

Capital Pool (End of Year 1): ₹3,032 Cr approx

3. Operational Pool Deployment

The remaining 30% of revenue (₹1,191 Cr in Year 1) funds direct worker benefits.

Upskill Wallet: ₹840 Cr : ₹500/month credits.

Health Insurance Subsidy: ₹351 Cr : premium reduction via co-pay with platforms.

5-Year Growth Plan: Scaling to 70 Lakh Workers

This roadmap outlines a phased expansion strategy that balances ambition with sustainability, ensuring that within 5 years, 70 Lakh (7 Million) workers are covered under the Upskill Wallet & Insurance program.

Core Assumptions:

- Benefits per Worker: ₹500/month Upskill Wallet + ₹600/month Insurance (50% subsidized): ₹9,600 per worker/year.
- Starting Base: 10 Lakh workers in Year 1.
- Target: 70 Lakh workers by Year 5.
- Revenue Growth: Platform cess + CSR grow at 10% annually.
- Partnership Growth: Grows at 15% annually.
- Investment Returns: 9.1% annual yield from Capital Pool.

Strategy:

Apply a 70/30 split (30% operating, 70% capital reserve). Early-year surplus is reinvested to fund later expansion.

Phased Rollout Roadmap

(All figures in ₹ Crores)

Year	Workers Covered	Operational Need	Total Revenue	Op. Pool Available	Surplus / (Gap)	Ending Capital Pool	Growth Action
1	10 Lakh	960	3,943	1,305	345	3,255	Solid start. Build reserves.
2	20 Lakh	1,920	4,583	1,517	-403	3,913	Double coverage.
3	35 Lakh	3,360	5,325	1,763	-1,597	4,688	Add 15L workers.
4	55 Lakh	5,280	6,186	2,048	-3,232	5,679	Add 20L workers.
5	70 Lakh	6,720	7,188	2,379	-4,341	6,904	Target Achieved.

Appendix 4

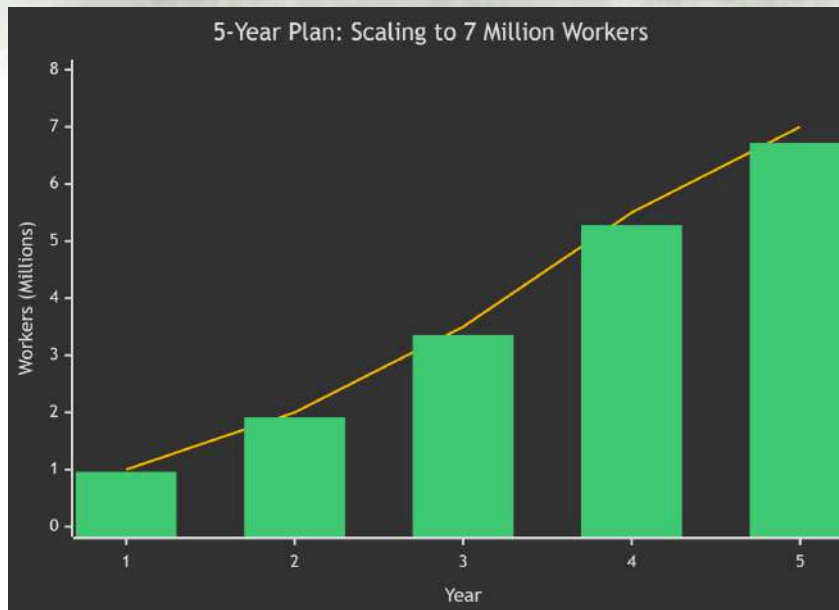
How the Model Works

Year 5 Detail:

Need for 70L Workers: 70 Lakh × ₹9,600 = ₹6,720 Cr

Op. Pool Available: ₹2,379 Cr Gap: ₹2,379 - ₹6,720 = ₹4,341 Cr

How it's Covered: This gap is comfortably covered by the combination of: The growth in annual revenue (which is ₹1,000+ Cr more than Year 1). The investment returns generated by the large and growing Capital Pool (which is nearly ₹7,000 Cr by Year 5).



• **Appendix 5 : Reasons to revenue growth assumptions :**

Streams	Growth driver	Why it is realistic and sustainable
Platform Cess (₹7 per transaction)	• More orders in Tier-2/3 cities • Metro users increase frequency • New gig sectors added • Economic growth boosts spending • Upskill Wallet improves workforce → higher demand	• The gig economy is still expanding; better workforce → better service → more transactions. • The per-transaction model scales directly with platform volume, making it predictable. • per-transaction model is inherently scalable and low-risk. As the platform's Gross Merchandise Volume (GMV) grows, the revenue grows predictably.
CSR Diversion (5% of CSR corpus)	Higher corporate profits grow CSR pool • More companies cross CSR threshold • Policy stability attracts investment • Reputational push to fund gig welfare	• The CSR corpus in India is rising yearly; 10% growth aligns with overall GDP & profit growth. The 2% mandate guarantees a stable share flows into the fund. It's a diversified, non-cyclical revenue stream tied to corporate profitability, not platform-specific risks.

• Details to Strategic Partnership Streams (Growth Engine)

Non-Gig Partnerships: Turning Welfare into a Growth Engine

Gig workers aren't just delivery agents—they're a mobile, hyper-visible workforce touching every corner of urban life. By collaborating with non-gig companies, we create a Win–Win–Win Ecosystem where companies, workers, and the Gig Welfare Fund all benefit.

The key structure :

- **Fast-Moving Consumer Goods & Retail:** Free samples and coupons in delivery packs → companies get direct consumer reach, workers get happier customers, and the fund earns service fees.
- **Telecom:** Cheap data plans for gig workers → telcos lock in millions of heavy users, workers save costs, fund gets revenue share.
- **Banks & NBFCs:** Bike/personal loans at lower interest using verified gig income → banks tap into a new credit market, workers get formal finance, and the fund earns referral fees.
- **Automotive:** Discounts on EVs & parts → companies gain loyal bulk buyers, workers cut costs, fund gets per-sale contributions.

• Publicity & Growth Strategy for CRaSH Policy :

It will not only safeguard gig workers but also evolve into a collaborative platform for growth, branding, and social impact. We plan to combine public engagement, corporate partnerships, and smart monetization models to ensure long-term sustainability.

1. VoiceSafe Portal as a PR & Collaboration Hub

We will showcase advertisements of NGOs, e-bike companies, health brands, and corporate sponsors on the portal.

Win for Companies: Strong public relations (PR) and brand visibility.

Win for Us: Trusted partnerships and sponsorship-driven funding.

2. Gig Marathon: Branding Meets Community Building

Organize annual Gig Marathons sponsored by brands (t-shirts, health drinks, wellness products).

These events will publicize welfare policies while also giving brands direct recognition.

Builds a positive ecosystem of visibility, worker pride, and sponsor loyalty.

3. VoiceSafe Premium: Data-Driven Insights

Offer a premium dashboard that analyzes grievance data and pinpoints specific problem areas for companies.

Value to Companies: Actionable insights for service & workplace improvement.

Revenue for crash: Subscription-based model for corporates.

4. Partnerships with Startups & Students

Collaborate with emerging startups and student innovators to co-develop APIs, chatbots, and portal features at lower cost.

Win for Startups and students: PR boost and real-world exposure, students get paid internships and real real-time project

Win for Us: Affordable, cutting-edge tech development.

5. Product Promotion Through Gig Network

Partner with beauty, wellness, and FMCG companies to distribute trial products via gig deliveries.

Customers who contribute a small premium (₹15 extra cess per order) get free products.

Triple Win:

Brands get low-cost, wide-scale promotion.

Customers feel rewarded.

Fund benefits from higher cess.

6. Strategic NGO & CSR Collaborations

Engage large NGOs and corporate foundations (e.g., Tata Trusts) to co-fund welfare schemes such as subsidized wallet insurance.

Builds credibility, social goodwill, and long-term funding.

This is not just publicity, it's a growth ecosystem where:

- **Companies gain PR, branding, and customer reach.**
- **Workers gain better welfare, benefits, and recognition.**
- **Crash policy gains funds, visibility, and long-term sustainability.**

Risk Analysis & Mitigation

Category	Risk	Description	Proposed Mitigation
Implementation & Compliance	Regulatory Delay & Pushback	States may delay forming welfare boards or setting wage floors. Platforms may lobby against mandatory contributions.	· Pilot in cooperative states (Karnataka, Rajasthan) to build proof of concept. · Anchor policy under Code on Social Security, 2020. · Use consumer support for welfare surcharge to create compliance pressure.
	Inter-Departmental Coordination	Requires coordination between multiple ministries, which is often slow.	· Create Gig Worker Welfare Board with cross-ministerial representation. · Define clear SLAs for each government body/platform. (service level agreement)
	Platform Non-Compliance	Platforms may under report transactions, delay payments, or ignore grievance mandates.	· Mandate API-based digital audits for real-time monitoring. · Impose strict penalties. · Public compliance dashboards to build reputational incentives.
Financial	Revenue Shortfalls	Economic downturns may reduce orders/CSR inflows.	· Diversify revenues (strategic partnerships, marathons, telecom, FMCG). – · Core-Satellite investment model (target ~9.1% returns).
	Unsustainable Scaling	Covering 7M workers in 5 years is aggressive; funding gap grows to ₹4,341 Cr by Yr-5.	· Build large reserve pool (70/30 capital split). · Cess revenue scales naturally with gig economy growth (10%+ annually).
	Mismanagement of Funds	Large pooled funds risk corruption or inefficiency.	· Multi-stakeholder oversight (govt, NGOs, gig workers). · Public dashboards with fund-use metrics. · Annual third-party audits.

Social & Market Acceptance	Worker Adoption	Workers may not trust or see value in grievance portals/training.	· Awareness campaigns and NGO partnerships. · Incentives via Upskill Wallet & “Safety Over Speed” schemes.
	Consumer Price Sensitivity	Surcharge may drive cost-sensitive customers to cheaper platforms.	· Transparent bill labeling (“Welfare Surcharge”). · Consumer choice: “Safe Delivery” option.
	Unintended Consequences	Hourly wages could reduce productivity; platforms may cut jobs.	· Hybrid wage model: base pay and performance bonus. · Shift caps (max 2 × 8 hrs) to distribute work fairly.
Skill Development	Time Availability for Upskilling	Gig workers may struggle to find time for courses while meeting daily earnings needs.	· Micro-learning modules (10–15 min mobile lessons). · Flexible scheduling with off-peak time slots.
	Post-Upskilling Utilization of Wallet	After completing courses, workers may want to use Upskill Wallet more broadly.	· Expand wallet usability: subsidized technical & administrative courses (digital marketing, logistics, accounting). · Partner with edtech platforms (Coursera, SWAYAM, UpGrad) for discounts. · Allow conversion into coupons (telecom/data packs, shopping vouchers) to build aspirational value.
Technological & Operational	Tech Infrastructure Failure	VoiceSafe, GPS tracking, Upskill Wallet could face glitches or cyberattacks.	· 9–12 month pilot phase for testing. · API integration with existing apps.
	Data Privacy & Security	Aadhaar-linked IDs, earnings, and health info are sensitive.	· Comply with DPDP Act, 2023. · Data encryption and strict access controls must be fundamental to the system design. · Anonymous reporting on VoiceSafe.
	Restaurant & Partner Buy-In	Restaurants may resist QuickPick counters due to cost/disruption.	· Start with high-volume corporate chains (McD, Domino’s). · Virtual queues for smaller restaurants to reduce burden.

Stakeholders involved -

Group	Entities	Interest	Engagement Strategy
1. Primary Beneficiaries	Gig Workers (delivery, ride-hailing, care, etc.)	Income stability, safety, mobility, dignity	Co-design workshops, app/NGO awareness drives, training incentives
2. Regulated Entities	Gig Platforms (Swiggy, Zomato, Ola, Uber, Urban Co.)	Profitability, compliance, stable workforce	Pilot incentives, API-based compliance, show ROI (₹15k Cr losses cut)
3. Government & Public Institutions	Labour Ministry	Workforce formalization, Social Security Code	Anchor policy under Code, lead Welfare Board
	MoRTH	Road safety, accident reduction	Share road data, joint safety campaigns
	Skill Ministry	Skilling targets	Integrate with Skill India/NSDC
	States & Municipalities	Local planning, road repair	Pilot in cooperative states, use road-quality API
	NITI Aayog	Data-driven growth	Position CRaSH as future-of-work model
4. Strategic Partners	NGOs & Civil Society	Welfare, awareness, safety	MOUs for training, grievance redressal
	Insurance Firms	New market, group policies	Low-cost group insurance, govt-backed
	Telecom/Banking	Financial inclusion, new customers	Bundled offers: data, low-interest loans

Appendix 7 : Frequently asked question (FAQ).

- **What is Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) as per the Companies Act, 2013, and under which Schedule activity will an initiative like the Upskill Wallet fall?**

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) is a statutory obligation under Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013, which requires any company having a net worth of ₹500 crore or more, turnover of ₹1,000 crore or more, or net profit of ₹5 crore or more to spend at least 2% of the average net profits of the last three financial years on approved social activities.

The Upskill Wallet initiative, aimed at education, skill development, and livelihood enhancement of workers, falls under Schedule VII activities relating to education, skill development, and livelihood promotion.

- **Gig economy workers often work on multiple platforms. In such a scenario, how can CSR contributions or welfare funds for initiatives like the Upskill Wallet be managed fairly among companies?**

- Large platforms contribute proportionally, based on the worker's time spent on their platform (e.g., if a worker earns ₹300 and spends 60% of their time on Swiggy, Swiggy pays 60% of the contribution and the rest is borne by other platforms).
- All contributions are pooled into a state/national Gig Worker Welfare Board (similar to Karnataka's model).
- Each registered gig worker is provided a unique ID linked to Aadhaar, allowing them to access a single consolidated Upskill Wallet, regardless of how many platforms they work on.

- **How can driving techniques be effectively taught to gig workers through virtual platforms?**

A hybrid training model (online + offline) can be implemented:

Online Modules : Cover theory aspects such as traffic rules, safe braking distances, fatigue management, driving in rainy/poor road conditions, accident response, and awareness of rider rights & laws.

Offline Practical Training : Conducted in partnership with RTOs, NSDC skill centers, ITIs, and NGOs, where workers undergo on-road practice sessions similar to existing driver training schools.

- **In the context of a Voicesafe Gig Worker grievance redressal portal: Who will design it? Who will own it? How will it function? And who will resolve the complaints?**

- Designing: The portal can be developed in collaboration with small startups and student interns from technology universities, ensuring innovation at a lower cost.
- Ownership: The system will be overseen by the Gig Worker Welfare Board, ensuring neutrality and accountability.
- Usage: Workers log complaints through the portal, accessible via web or mobile, using their unique worker ID.
- Complaint Handling & Resolution: A dedicated team will review complaints, investigate, and coordinate with platforms or authorities. Serious or repeated violations can be escalated to government officials or regulatory/legal bodies for formal resolution, ensuring legitimacy and enforcement.
- **Why should a delivery platform invest in hourly base pay and skilling policies, and how can it save money for the company?**

Delivery platforms already incur hidden losses through high attrition, low worker skills, accidents, and customer dissatisfaction. By providing hourly base pay and investing in skilling, companies can reduce these losses, improve efficiency, and enhance customer retention. A portion of the incentives and bonuses already being paid can be restructured into stable base pay, making the policy cost-neutral in the long run while saving money through reduced churn and service disruptions.

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